

Employee Leave Policy

Governs entitlement, application, and administration of all leave categories for permanent employees.

Document No.	HR-POL-004	Version	3.2
Effective Date	01 April 2026	Policy Owner	Head of Human Resources
Applicability	All permanent, full-time employees (India operations)	Review Cycle	Annual

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy defines the types of leave available to employees, eligibility criteria, accrual mechanics, and the process for requesting and approving leave. It applies to all permanent, full-time employees across all locations and departments. It does not apply to interns, consultants, or employees engaged on a fixed-term contract of less than six months, who are covered under Annexure C of the Contractor Engagement Policy.

2. Leave Categories and Entitlement

The table below summarizes annual entitlement by leave type. Entitlement is prorated for employees who join or separate mid-year, calculated on a per-completed-month basis.

Leave Type	Annual Entitlement	Accrual	Carry Forward	Encashable
Casual Leave (CL)	12 days	1 day/month	Max 6 days to next year	No
Sick Leave (SL)	10 days	Credited on Jan 1	Not carried forward	No
Privilege/Earned Leave (EL)	18 days	1.5 days/month	Max 45 days accumulated	Yes, on separation
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	One-time, on request	N/A	No
Paternity Leave	10 working days	One-time, on request	Must be used within 3 months of birth	No
Bereavement Leave	5 working days	Per event	N/A	No
Marriage Leave	3 working days	Once per employment	N/A	No

2.1 Eligibility Waiting Period

Casual Leave and Sick Leave may be availed from the date of joining. Privilege Leave accrues from day one but may only be availed after completion of 90 days of continuous service. Employees on probation are eligible for all

leave types except Privilege Leave, which activates automatically upon confirmation.

2.2 Maternity Leave — Detailed Provisions

Maternity leave of 26 weeks is applicable to employees who have worked for at least 80 days in the 12 months preceding the expected delivery date, in line with the Maternity Benefit Act. For employees with two or more surviving children, entitlement is reduced to 12 weeks. Up to 8 weeks may be availed before the expected delivery date. A medical certificate from a registered practitioner is mandatory to initiate the leave.

2.3 Sick Leave — Certification Requirement

Sick leave of up to 2 consecutive days may be availed without a medical certificate. For any sick leave exceeding 2 consecutive days, a medical certificate must be submitted to the reporting manager and uploaded to the HRMS within 5 working days of resuming work. Failure to submit certification will result in the leave being marked as Leave Without Pay (LWP).

3. Leave Application Process

All leave requests must be submitted through the HRMS portal at least 3 working days in advance for planned leave (CL, EL, marriage leave). Sick leave may be applied for retrospectively on the day of resuming work, but the manager must be informed by phone, chat, or email on the day of absence itself.

- Step 1: Raise a leave request in the HRMS with dates, leave type, and reason.
- Step 2: Reporting manager approves or rejects within 2 working days.
- Step 3: On approval, the leave is auto-reflected in the attendance and payroll system.
- Step 4: Unapproved leave beyond 5 consecutive days requires additional approval from the department head.

4. Leave Without Pay (LWP)

Where an employee has exhausted their applicable leave balance, any further absence will be treated as Leave Without Pay, subject to manager approval. LWP exceeding 15 consecutive days in a calendar year requires written approval from HR Business Partner and may affect annual increment and bonus eligibility, as detailed in the Compensation Policy (HR-POL-011).

5. Public Holidays

The organization observes 10 paid public holidays annually, published as a location-wise calendar at the start of each calendar year on the HR portal. Employees required to work on a declared holiday due to business need are entitled to a compensatory off, to be availed within 30 days, or holiday pay at 2x the daily rate, at the employee's discretion.

6. Leave Encashment on Separation

Unutilized Privilege Leave, up to the accumulated cap of 45 days, is encashed at the time of final settlement based on the employee's last drawn basic salary. Casual Leave and Sick Leave balances lapse and are not encashable under any circumstance.

7. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Can I take Casual Leave and Sick Leave together for a long absence?

A: Yes, but any combined absence exceeding 5 consecutive days will require department head approval regardless of which leave types are combined.

Q: What happens if I resign while on maternity leave?

A: The notice period clock begins from the date the resignation letter is submitted, irrespective of leave status. Employees are encouraged to consult HR before resigning during maternity leave, as it may affect benefit continuity.

Q: Is Privilege Leave entitlement the same for part-time employees?

A: No. Part-time employees accrue Privilege Leave on a pro-rata basis calculated against their contracted weekly hours relative to a standard 40-hour week.

This document supersedes Employee Leave Policy v3.1 dated 01 April 2025. For queries, contact hr-policy@company.example.